

Romi Hill

romihill@bu.edu ♦ romihill.github.io

Last Updated: May 2026

EDUCATION

Boston University

PhD in Linguistics

September 2024 - 2029 (expected)

Boston, Massachusetts

University of Konstanz

Master of Speech and Language Processing

October 2021 - February 2024

Konstanz, Germany

Specialization: Machine Language Processing

Thesis Title: Syntactic Constraints on the Morphophonology of Reduplication: A Theoretical and Computational Perspective

University of Melbourne

Bachelor of Arts (Honours) & Concurrent Diploma in Mathematics

February 2015 - December 2019

Melbourne, Australia

Major: Linguistics & Applied Linguistics

Diploma Specialisation: Discrete Mathematics and Operations Research

Thesis Title: Murrinhpatha Noun Classifiers - Syntax and Discourse Functions

Ludwig Maximilian University

Exchange Student

March 2017 - July 2017

Munich, Germany

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Interactions at the syntax-phonology interface, non-concatenative morphology, argument structure, language documentation

PUBLICATIONS

Language Documentation & Conservation

2023

WordSpinner: Developing a tool to convert plain-text lexicon files into dictionary webpages

[Link]

Authors: Caroline Jones, Jesse Tran, Eleanor Jorgensen, **Romi Hill**, Patricia Ellis, Jane Simpson, Felicity Meakins, Ben Foley, Marcel Reverter-Rambaldi, Lowana Tudor-Smith, Paul Williams, Clair Hill, Mark Richards, Quang Vinh Nguyen

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Proceedings of the 20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences (ICPhS)

2023

R. Skarnitzl and J. Volín (eds.).

pp. 1459 - 1464

The phonetics-phonology-syntax interface: a computational implementation

[Link]

Authors: Tina Bögel, **Romi Hill**, Justin Hofenbitzer, Tianyi Zhao

CONFERENCE TALKS

Boston Morphology Workshop (Exo-Words 4)

Poster Presentation

May 2026

[\[Link\]](#)

Infixation on the CV Tier: Evidence from Alabama Agent Agreement

Authors: **Romi Hill**

Linguistic Society of America (LSA)

Accepted as Poster Presentation

January 2026

[\[Link\]](#)

Voice-mismatch Reciprocals in Indonesian as Binary Predicate Conjunction

Authors: Elizabeth Coppock, **Romi Hill**, Neil Myler

Association of Contemporary African Linguistics 56 (ACAL)

Accepted as Poster Presentation

May 2025

[\[Link\]](#)

Morphosyntactic Constraints on the Morphophonology of Reduplication

Authors: **Romi Hill**

ACADEMIC PRESENTATIONS

WOLF Lab @ Harvard University

Invited Talk

September 2022

Cambridge, MA

Syntactic Constraints on the Morphophonology on Reduplication in Bantu

Presenters: **Romi Hill**

University of Edinburgh

Invited Talk

September 2022

Edinburgh, Scotland

The prosody-syntax interface: theoretical assumptions and computational implementation

Presenters: Tina Bögel, **Romi Hill**, Justin Hofenbitzer, Tianyi Zhao

Australian Languages Workshop

Presentation

February 2020

Queensland, Australia

Murrinhpatha noun classifiers: Syntax and discourse functions

Presenters: **Romi Hill**, Rachel Nordlinger, John Mansfield

Australian National University

Presentation

January 2019

Canberra, Australia

Two projects: Computational methods for corpus and dictionary-making: Warlpiri corpus and Dhurga dictionary

Presenters: **Romi Hill**, Eleanor Jorgensen

TEACHING ASSISTANT EMPLOYMENT

University of Konstanz

Core Components of Language B

October 2023 - February 2024

University of Konstanz

Master's course on the foundations of syntax, semantics and pragmatics. *[Also October 2022 - February 2023.]*

I prepared weekly exercises and solutions, and marked assignments.

Instructor: Colin Davis.

University of Konstanz*Statistics*

October 2023 - February 2024

University of Konstanz

Masters course on linear and logistic regression for linguistics.

I prepared weekly exercises and solutions.

Instructor: Massimiliano Canzi.**University of Konstanz***Finite State Morphology*

September 2023

University of Konstanz

Undergraduate course on finite state morphology with XFST.

I assisted students with theoretical and technical questions in class.

Instructor: Tina Bögel.**University of Konstanz***English Syntax*

April 2023 - July 2023

University of Konstanz

Undergraduate course on an introduction to syntactic theory, with a focus on English.

I prepared weekly exercises and solutions, and marked assignments.

Instructor: Colin Davis.**University of Melbourne***PASS Leader*

February 2019 - November 2019

University of Melbourne

I facilitated “Peer Assisted Study Sessions”: weekly study sessions led by a high-achieving student who has successfully completed the subject in the previous year.

I was a PASS leader for two third-year linguistics subjects:

Semantics

Instructor: Jonathon Lum

Exploring Linguistic Diversity

Instructor: Barbara Kelly

I prepared questions and discussion topics, and mentored students around university life.

RESEARCH ASSISTANT EMPLOYMENT**Prosodic Structure at the Interface Between Language and Speech**

March 2022 - March 2024

*Project leads:**University of Konstanz**Tina Bögel (University of Konstanz)*[\[Link\]](#)*Catherine Lai & Alice Turk (University of Edinburgh)*

Collaborated on developing a prosody-syntax interface within the Lexical Functional Grammar framework, incorporating language redundancy information; implemented this interface in a computational XLE grammar; and wrote a Python script to calculate average syllable durations in German as a measure of acoustic salience.

Information Structure and Questions in Urdu/Hindi

December 2021 - January 2022

*Project lead:**University of Konstanz**Miriam Butt (University of Konstanz)*[\[Link\]](#)

Wrote Praat scripts for Urdu phonetic transcriptions to extract prosodic information from non-canonical questions. The scripts automated tasks including calculation of average phoneme, syllable, word, and utterance durations; mean word intensity; extraction of F0 values at equidistant time points; identification of pre-word pauses; and general TextGrid file management.

Are super-complex words represented like sentences in speakers' minds? May 2021 - September 2021

Project leads:

University of Melbourne

Brett Baker (University of Melbourne)

[\[Link\]](#)

Rikke Bundgaard-Nielsen (Western Sydney University)

Contributed to an ARC-funded project on speakers' knowledge of "super-complex" words in the Australian language Wubuy. Wrote Python scripts to clean a Wubuy XML corpus into HTML, automate interlinear glossing, and implement phonological rules to generate variants of dictionary headwords. These outputs supported calculations of information density as a measure of word complexity.

Learning to tell a narrative in Murrinhpatha

May 2021 - July 2021

Project leads:

University of Melbourne

Barbara Kelly, Gillian Wigglesworth,

[\[Link\]](#)

& Lucy Davidson (University of Melbourne)

Contributed to an ARC-funded project on children's linguistic skills in the polysynthetic language Murrinhpatha. Used ELAN to code information structure in children's narrative videos and developed a controlled vocabulary to target relevant aspects of information structure.

Nafsan Corpus

November 2019 - January 2020

Project lead:

Melbourne, Australia

Rosey Billington (University of Melbourne)

Contributed to a corpus of the Oceanic language Nafsan by correcting phonetic transcription boundaries in Praat.

Summer Scholar

November 2018 - January 2019

Supervisors:

Australian National University

Jane Simpson & Hanna Suominen (Australian National University)

Summer scholar funded by the Australian Signals Directorate, contributing to two projects using computational methods for linguistic outcomes. Developed a workflow with forced alignment techniques for a Warlpiri corpus, including testing aligners, creating guidelines, and supporting non-technical users. Collaborated with a community leader to build a revival dictionary for Dhurga using HTML/CSS, and contributed to WordSpinner, a tool for online dictionaries of under-resourced languages.

INDUSTRY EMPLOYMENT

Appen

January 2020 - July 2021

Computational Linguist

Sydney, Australia

Developed high-quality training data for diverse NLP projects, including TTS/ASR pronunciation lexicons, NER annotation, text generation, and tool development. Used Python, regex, and linguistic expertise.

Real Thing AI

July 2021 - October 2021

Conversational Designer

Melbourne, Australia

Served as subject matter expert in linguistics for RealSAM, a voice-command system for Blind and Visually Impaired users, advising the CEO and engineers on dialogue design to improve natural language understanding.

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Duckling Lab <i>Lab Member</i>	January 2026 - Present <i>Boston University</i>
Boston Morphology Workshop <i>Co-Organizer</i>	May 2026 <i>Boston University</i>
The 50th Boston University Conference on Language Development <i>Co-Organizer</i>	June 2025 - December 2025 <i>Boston University</i>
Structures of Under-Research Languages Lab (SULa) <i>Lab Member</i>	September 2024 - Present <i>Boston University</i>
WOLF Lab <i>Affiliated Member</i>	January 2025 - Present <i>Harvard University</i>
The 49th Boston University Conference on Language Development <i>Participant, Registration Volunteer</i>	November 2024 <i>Boston University</i>
Basque Summer Tutorial in Language Documentation <i>Participant</i>	August 2022 <i>Larrau, France</i>
CoEDL Summer School Workshop <i>Participant, Volunteer Helping Assistant</i>	November 2019 <i>Melbourne, Australia</i>
CoEDL Summer School Workshop <i>Participant</i>	November 2018 <i>Canberra, Australia</i>

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Computational Languages	Python, C, SQL, HTML & CSS, JavaScript, R, Praat scripting, XLE, XFST
Command Line Interfaces	bash/zsh, sed, git
Text Editing	LaTeX, vim, regex, VSCode
Linguistics Software	ELAN, Praat, FLEx, WebMAUS
Human Languages	Native Australian English, B2 German, Beginner's Mandarin Chinese

AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

Begabtenbefreiungssatzung <i>Exemption to Pay International Fees</i>	2022 - 2024 <i>University of Konstanz</i>
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Identified as a particularly gifted international student, and received an exemption to pay international fees.

DAAD Scholarship (Master Studies for All Academic Disciplines) <i>Scholarship</i>	2022 - 2023 <i>University of Konstanz</i>
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Monthly scholarship payments for excellently-qualified graduates. The scholarship is awarded by an independent selection committee, and selection is based on academic achievements, relevant internships and work experience, quality of the study project, and potential of the applicant.

Value: Monthly payments of €934.

R.G. Wilson Scholarship

2019

*Scholarship**University of Melbourne*

Three scholarships awarded to the highest average honours students in the Faculty of Arts.

Value: One-off payment of AU\$3,200.

Dwight Final Assessment Prize

2019

*Prize**University of Melbourne*

Awarded to the highest achieving honours student in Linguistics.

Value: One-off payment of AU\$1,600.

Dean's Honours List

2019

*Recognition**University of Melbourne*

Awarded to the top 3% of students within each year of the program in the Bachelor of Arts.

Appen Prize for Excellence in Linguistics

2018

*Prize**University of Melbourne*

Awarded to the highest achieving Linguistics student across all their Linguistics subjects, who goes on to enrol in honours.

Value: One-off payment of AU\$1,000.

Melbourne Global Scholars Award

2017

*Scholarship**University of Melbourne*

Awarded to high achieving students who are undertaking overseas study for 12 weeks or more.

Value: One-off payment of AU\$2,500.

REFERENCES

Neil Myler*Associate Professor in Linguistics*

Boston University

myler@bu.edu

Colin Davis*Associate Professor of English Linguistics*

Nord University

colin.davis@nord.no

Tina Bögel*Postdoctoral Researcher in Linguistics*

University of Konstanz

tina.boegel@uni-konstanz.de

Miriam Butt*Professor in Linguistics*

University of Konstanz

miriam.butt@uni-konstanz.de